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Rajakarier, Group Chief Executive Officer of Minor International.

Economically, the logic is simple. “Branded residences can serve as a powerful tool for accelerating ROI in hospitality projects and, in some cases, even support funding of the overall development,” says a spokesperson of Hotelivate, a hospitality consulting firm. In saturated residential markets such as Delhi NCR and Mumbai, the added value or premium from hospitality branding is still being tested. However, in leisure destinations, with a lack of luxury developments, the premium achievable on branded holiday homes can be significant, he adds.

Brands enjoy asset-light growth: licensing their name and expertise without large capital outlays. Buyers receive homes linked to a globally recognised name, along with property management services and resale advantages.

“For developers, these projects differentiate them in an increasingly crowded luxury market,” says Akash Datta, Managing Direc-

▲ SPOTTING TRENDS

Though still at an early stage, activity is picking up in Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi-NCR, and Hyderabad

tor (South Asia) at HVS ANAROCK. “For hotel brands, it opens lucrative revenue streams while building deeper engagement with customers beyond their hotels.”

Underlying the expansion is a demographic shift. Rising affluence, combined with globalised tastes and brand consciousness, is pushing Indian buyers toward projects that offer not just square footage, but an entire lifestyle. According to Knight Frank, India’s HNI population, estimated at 85,698 in 2024 is expected to rise to 93,753 by 2028.

Developers and operators say today’s buyers seek wellness amenities, sustainable design, and expansive living spaces. Dedicated concierge services, private clubs, sky lounges, and gourmet dining are now considered standard features. For non-resident Indians, branded residences also serve as a reliable investment and a foothold in India’s luxury market. **BT**

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